

Guidelines for Street Food Hub

Table of Contents

<u>1. BACKGROUND</u>	<u>3</u>
<u>2. OBJECTIVES</u>	<u>3</u>
<u>3. STREET FOOD HUB</u>	<u>3</u>
<u>4. PREREQUISITES FOR STREET FOOD HUB</u>	<u>3</u>
<u>5. NON-PERMISSIBLE ACTIVITIES</u>	<u>4</u>
<u>6. SELECTION OF LOCATIONS</u>	<u>4</u>
<u>7. IMPLEMENTATION PLAN.....</u>	<u>4</u>
<u>8. CONVERGENCE</u>	<u>5</u>
<u>9. ROLE OF STATE/UTS & ULBS/DISTRICT.....</u>	<u>6</u>
<u>10. FUNDING PATTERN</u>	<u>6</u>
<u>11. PROCEDURE FOR RELEASE OF FUNDS.....</u>	<u>6</u>
<u>12. IMPLEMENTATION SCHEDULE</u>	<u>7</u>
<u>13. PROJECT MONITORING & EVALUATION</u>	<u>7</u>
<u>ANNEXURE 1</u>	<u>8</u>
<u>DETAILED PROPOSAL.....</u>	<u>8</u>
<u>ANNEXURE 2</u>	<u>11</u>
<u>KEY BASELINE INFORMATION.....</u>	<u>11</u>
<u>ANNEXURE 3.....</u>	<u>12</u>
<u>COMPOSITION OF THE COMMITTEE</u>	<u>12</u>

<u>ANNEXURE 4</u>	<u>13</u>
EVALUATION CRITERIA.....	13

1. Background

Street vendors are an important contributor in the Indian economy offering affordable goods and services. A major set of the vendors deals in street foods for their livelihoods. However, street food vending is largely informal and unregulated, often leading to non-adherence to food safety norms. With structured policies and adequate training, street food vendors can create organized and hygienic food spaces.

In this context, under the PM SVANidhi Scheme, upto 50 Street Food Hubs will be developed across India with high footfall, particularly at major tourist and pilgrimage locations, showcasing distinct local cuisines. The initiative encompasses infrastructure design, vendor operations, hygiene protocols, waste management, and safety measures.

2. Objectives

- To develop Street Food Hubs meeting global standards
- To promote the local culinary heritage by supporting traditional street food in high tourist footfall areas.
- To create street vending ecosystem that ensures dignified livelihoods and a superior vending experience.
- To create an experience zone for customers.

3. Street Food Hub

3.1 A Street Food Hub is a cluster of street vendors, with at least 50% engaged in street food vending preferably into local cuisine while meeting basic hygiene and safety standards.

These hubs will be designated as **SVANidhi Street Food Hubs** ensuring food safety and hygiene standards and certification/accreditation of all food vendors by FSSAI.

3.2 The hubs shall be developed with a holding capacity of minimum **50 vending units** spread across not more than 2 clusters.

4. Prerequisites for Street Food Hub

4.1 MoHUA encourages establishment of Street Food Hubs at locations with strong potential for long-term viability, sustained footfall, and high impact.

4.2 These hubs will primarily be developed through brownfield interventions by upgrading existing vending areas or natural street food markets into organised, hygienic, and well-equipped Street Food Hubs

4.3 Adequate and encumbrance-free land shall be provided by State Government or local authority, permitted for commercial activities.

5. Non-Permissible Activities

5.1 The following activities will be considered ineligible under the project (the list is only indicative and not exhaustive) :-

- i. Land Acquisition Cost
- ii. Permanent/Concrete Shops
- iii. Working capital for Street Vendors
- iv. Permanent allocation of space to Street Vendors
- v. Allocation of space/vending unit to Street Vendors without Certificate of Vending/Letter of Recommendation

6. Selection of Locations

6.1 As the focus under the scheme is to develop Street Food Hubs in places of tourist, religious and cultural importance, ULBs/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns falling under the PRASHAD/HRIDAY Scheme, Swadesh Darshan Scheme of Ministry of Tourism and UNESCO World Heritage Sites & Creative Cities would be eligible to apply.

6.2 However any ULBs/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns not included in above schemes but known for its local cuisine and major tourist attraction with high footfall may send proposal for the development of street food hub.

6.3 The team/experts from MoHUA may undertake site visits as part of the pre-approval process.

7. Implementation Plan

7.1 ULBs/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns will submit detailed proposals (*as per Annexure 1*) along with baseline information (as per *Annexure 2*), on the portal within 90 days from the launch of the component. The submission period may, however, be extended under special circumstances.

(Proposal shall be submitted by Municipal Commissioner for ULBs and District Collector/District Magistrate for Census towns/Peri-urban areas to the State/UTs).

7.2 The submitted proposals shall be evaluated by the State Level Monitoring Committee and shall be further recommended to the National Level Committee for approval.

7.3 The shortlisted proposals submitted by the State/UT, shall be presented before the National Level committee chaired by Secretary, MoHUA. The composition of committee is specified in **Annexure 3**.

(The evaluation criteria are specified in **Annexure 4**)

Note: To ensure equitable regional representation, due consideration shall be given to proposals from all States/UTs while approving projects. Not more than five proposals shall be permitted from a single State.

8. Convergence

8.1 To ensure effective implementation and long-term sustainability of the component, convergence with key Ministries, institutions, and stakeholders shall be pursued as outlined below:

Ministry of Tourism

- Suggestive list of strategic cities/areas with high tourism potential
- Rating of Street Food Hubs through reputed national and international agencies
- Inclusion of prominent Street Food Hubs in official tourism itineraries
- Training of street vendors in upskilling, food handling, presentation, and customer service through Institutes of Hotel Management (IHMs).

Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)

- Capacity-building programmes on food safety, hygiene, packaging and regulatory compliance

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- Engagement of trained volunteers for on-ground support, supervision, and feedback to improve operations and service delivery.

Urban Self-Help Groups (SHGs)

- Participation in operations and maintenance of created assets, contributing to community ownership and local employment.

Department of Financial Services (DFS)

- Facilitation of access to credit for street vendors to enable procurement of improved cooking equipment, tools and other required material including working capital.

9. Role of State/UTs & ULBs/District

9.1 The State/UT Level Monitoring Committee (as per scheme guidelines) will be responsible for evaluation and recommendation of the project to the Ministry and monitoring of progress after its approval by the Ministry.

9.2 The local authority shall be responsible for identification & development of suitable street food hubs, FSSAI training of all street vendors and its operations & maintenance. ULBs/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns shall constitute a monitoring committee chaired by the Municipal Commissioner/District Collector/Executive Officer for effective implementation of the component.

10. Funding Pattern

10.1 The MoHUA will provide financial assistance of up to ₹ 4 crore under the SUSV sub-component of the PM SVANidhi Scheme, for every street food hub approved for development. Concerned ULBs shall also be eligible for financial assistance of ₹25 lakh upon notification of the vending zones in the city.

10.2 In addition, ULBs/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns are advised to leverage funds available under other ongoing State/Central Schemes or CSR funds etc. and to ensure convergence with other existing Government Schemes.

11. Procedure for Release of Funds

11.1 Funds for the development of Street Food Hubs will be disbursed directly to the selected ULBs/Districts by the Ministry. The release of funds will be carried out in three tranches:

- 1st Tranche: 30% on the approval of the project by MoHUA.
- 2nd Tranche: 50% of the total approved amount will be released upon submission of Utilization Certificate (UC) of the 75% of 1st tranche
- 3rd Tranche: The remaining 20% will be released on satisfactory report by the Independent Assessment Agency

11.2 At least two visits will be carried out by third-party assessment agency (Independent Review and Monitoring Agency) selected by MoHUA during the implementation of the project.

12.Implementation Schedule

12.1 After the approval, the time schedule for completion and operationalization of individual projects will be maximum of 9 months from the date of release of 1st instalment:

12.2 The timeline for various activities under the project is as follows:

S.No.	Activities	Timelines (months)
1	Tendering, Awarding of work	2
2	Construction & Regulatory Compliances including training of food street vendors by FSSAI	6
3	Allotment & Operationalization	1

It is preferable that the O&M of these street food hubs is undertaken by groups or associations of street vendors themselves, or by SHGs.

13.Project Monitoring & Evaluation

13.1 The complete workflow of this component covering proposal submission, recommendation, approval and real-time monitoring of project will be done through PM SVANidhi Portal.

13.2 An Oversight Committee shall be constituted for regular monitoring of operations and maintenance of the Street Food Hub. The Committee shall meet at least once every six months to oversee the quality standards. The Secretary, MoHUA shall be the Chair, with the Secretary, Tourism as Alternate Chair. The composition of the committee is specified in **Annexure 3**.

13.3 As far as interpretation of any of the provisions of these guidelines is concerned, the decision of the Mission Directorate, PM SVANidhi shall be final.

Detailed Proposal

Particulars	Details
Name of ULB/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns	
Location/Address	
Executing Agency	
Eligibility Criteria/Mandatory The ULB/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns shall meet the following criteria: • Availability of encumbrance free govt. land with permissible land use for street vending. • Supporting land documents	
Components of Proposal	
1. Location The proposal should articulate the rationale for selection of the location of street food vending hub, including: • Proximity to Tourist Core • Tourist Footfall Intensity • Role in Destination Itinerary • Visibility & Accessibility	
2. Size & Scale The proposal should specify the following: • Total area to be used for the vending hub • The holding capacity (i.e., number of street vendors to be accommodated in the vending hub) • No of customers to be accommodated	
3. Design The proposal shall provide: Site Plan outlining overall layout including: ○ pedestrian-friendly circulation ○ uniform stalls and signage ○ seating, lighting, and rest areas ○ shaded spaces ○ natural landscape for climate comfort and aesthetics ○ amenities and services to be provided for vendors and	

customers* • Waste and Odour Management measures for scientific waste handling without nuisance	
4. Aesthetic & Place-making potential The proposal shall elaborate on: • Potential for visual enhancement • Scope for streetscape and design regulation • Potential to resonate with youth and emerging trends	
5. Visitor Experience Enhancement • Provision for Cultural Integration Potential • Plan for suitability for evening/night time use	
6. Cost breakdown and financial feasibility A comprehensive budget must be prepared, detailing the total estimated cost across all key components including design, construction, operations and maintenance, branding, and other relevant heads along with cost of abstract. This should include clear projections of Capital Expenditure (Capex), Operational Expenditure (Opex) on an annual basis, and estimated annual revenue.	
7. Operations & Maintenance Plan The proposal shall outline a comprehensive O&M plan for the day-to-day management of the Vending Hub including details of: • Responsible O&M agency • Process and Criteria for selection of O&M agency • Source of funding for O&M • Initiatives for footfall and future expansions • Revenue Generation model through various activities • Vendor fees/rent • Facility upkeep • Collaboration with stakeholders to facilitate smooth functioning of the Hub • Dedicated O&M staff	
8. Branding Plan The proposal shall specify a plan outlining measures to promote the market and attract sustained visitor footfall.	

9. Capacity Building Plan • Provision for FSSAI-led training on food safety, hygiene, and packaging • Training on digital onboarding and transactions • Upskilling of vendors in food handling, presentation, and customer service	
10. Inclusive and Accessibility Plan • Measures for safe, inclusive, and barrier-free access, including for persons with disabilities • Provision for participation of women and traditional vendors	
11. Monitoring, Evaluation & Feedback Mechanism The proposal shall specify: • Mechanism for monitoring project progress and compliance throughout the project lifecycle • System for collecting vendor and customer feedback for continuous improvement • Plan to meet Clean Street Food Hub Standards	
12. Project Milestones and Timelines The proposal shall specify: • Key milestones for the project, completion of construction, regulatory compliances, market operationalization etc. • A clear timeline for the entire project, from approval to completion.	

Note:

- 1. The ULB/Peri Urban Area/Census Towns may adopt the practices for vending zone/market as per their State/UT Rules/Schemes wherever applicable*
- *Indicative list of essential Amenities and Services*
 - Toilets for men and women*
 - Drinking water facility*
 - Hand-washing facility*
 - Designated washing areas for utensils and vegetables*
 - Proper drainage system*
 - Electricity supply and lighting arrangement*
 - Seating arrangement*
 - Nearby Parking facility*
 - Signage within the premises etc.*
 - Fire safety*
 - CCTV surveillance*

Key Baseline Information

1. Name and address of the street food hub/market with photographs and geo-tagged location.
2. Names of the local cuisine to be sold at the hub (Famous locally)
3. Notification status of the area as a designated vending zone.
4. Brief overview of the importance and significance of the City and Market
5. Description of the predominant nature of vending (types of foods or products to be sold).
6. Annual tourist footfall in the ULB/ Peri Urban Area/Census Towns
7. Daily footfall or average customer visits in the market or street.
8. Total length of the vending street (in meters) and hub area (in sq.meter.).
9. Traffic circulation details, indicating whether the street is pedestrian-only or open to vehicular movement.
10. Total number of street vendors vending in the market.
11. Number of street vendors who are PM SVANidhi beneficiaries.
12. Number of street vendors with FSSAI training certification.
13. Number of street vendors with FSSAI registration/license.
14. Number of street vendors who are digitally active
15. Existing infrastructure facilities:
 - Pavement and drainage status
 - Washrooms
 - Cleaning area
 - Electricity and lighting
 - Parking facility
 - Hand washing facility
 - Dustbins
 - Drinking water facility
 - Other
16. Existing arrangements of solid waste management – collection, transportation and disposal.

Composition of the Committee

1. National Level Committee (NLC) for approvals

S. No	Designation	Role
1	Secretary, MoHUA	Chairperson
2	Mission Director, PM SVANidhi	Convenor
3	Representative nominated by Ministry of Tourism	Member
4	Representative from Department of Financial Services (DFS)	Member
5	Representative from Central Public Works Department (CPWD)	Member
6	Representative from tourism/ F&B operator as nominated by Ministry of Tourism	Member
7	Representative from Town and Country Planning Organization (TCPO)	Member
8	Dy.Advisor/Jt.Advisor, CPHEEO	Member
9	Any other member(s) co-opted by the Chairperson	Members

2. Oversight Committee

S. No	Designation	Role
1	Secretary, MoHUA	Chairperson
2	Secretary, Ministry of Tourism	Co-Chairperson
3	Mission Director, PM SVANidhi	Convenor
4	Representative from tourism/ F&B operator as nominated by Ministry of Tourism	Member
5	Any other member(s) co-opted by the Chairperson	Members

Evaluation Criteria

The following evaluation framework may be considered:

Sn	Selection Parameter	Objective / What to Assess	Indicative Evidence / Inputs Required	Max Score
A. Location Relevance				
1	Proximity to Tourist Core	Closeness to major tourist/pilgrimage/heritage attraction	Distance map, walking-time assessment	5
2	Tourist Footfall Intensity	Adequacy and consistency of tourist footfall	Footfall estimates, seasonality data	5
3	Role in Destination Itinerary	Potential to function as a planned stop or activity node	Tourism plans, destination master plan reference	5
4	Visibility & Accessibility	Ease of identification and safe access from tourist routes	Location map, site photos, pedestrian access note	5
Subtotal (A)				20
B. Design Relevance				
5	Pedestrian-friendly Layout Potential	Ability to support walkable, linger-friendly public space	ROW width, site layout, photos	5
6	Scope for Standardised Kiosks	Ability to introduce uniform stalls and signage	Design concept	5
7	Comfort Potential	Feasibility of seating, lighting, and rest areas	Concept sketch, Shading, seating and roofing plan	5
8		Provision of proper shading, covering seating, rest and vending areas		5
9	Natural Sync	Integration of natural landscape for climate comfort and aesthetics	Landscape plan, plantation proposal, shading through trees/green buffers	5
10	Amenities & Services	Availability of water, drainage, toilets, hand wash	Civic services note, utility layout	5
11	Waste & Odour Management	Scientific waste handling without nuisance	SWM linkage plan	5
Subtotal (B)				35

C. Visitor Experience Enhancement				
12	Cultural Integration Potential	Scope to reflect local food culture and traditions	Local cuisine mapping, cultural assets	10
13	Day & Night Activation Potential	Suitability for safe evening/night-time use	Lighting, policing, land-use compatibility	5
Subtotal (C)				15
D. Food Hygiene & Safety Compliance				
14	FSSAI Compliance Readiness	Ability to meet Clean Street Food Hub standards Including FSSAI training and FSSAI registration/license	Preliminary FSSAI checklist	5
Subtotal (D)				5
E. Aesthetic & Place-making Potential				
15	Visual Upgrade Potential	Potential to transform area into clean, attractive space	Before/after visual assessment	5
16	Streetscape & Design Control	Degree of control over frontage and public realm	ULB ownership / NOC	5
17	Youth / Trend Appeal	Potential to emerge as a trendy, aspirational hotspot	User profile, nearby activity zones	5
Subtotal (E)				15
F. Vendor & Livelihood Integration				
18	Existing Vendor Base	Presence of vendors suitable for organisation	Vendor survey / Records	5
19	Inclusion & Equity Potential	Scope to include women/traditional vendors	Vendor profile data	5
Subtotal (F)				10
G. Implementation Readiness				
19	Operation & Maintenance Plan	Ability to sustain cleanliness and infrastructure	O&M plan, responsible agency	10
20	Branding Plan	Measures to promote the market and attract sustained visitor footfall	Branding and communication strategy	5
Subtotal (G)				15
Total				115

- An additional 35 marks will be allotted for the presentation.
